

Google Dorking, Shodan & Censys

Google dorking: search operators as exploit starters

site:ex.com filetype:sql	config dumps
site:ex.com filetype:env	environment secrets
site:ex.com intitle:"index of"	open directories
site:ex.com inurl:admin	admin portals
"password" "ex.com" filetype:log	leaked credentials
inurl:"/api/" filetype:json	API surface

The point isn't to find "one password" – it is to map **what data leaks by default** and prove it in a report.

Shodan: the internet's scanner

Search banners, ports, services, org names

Query ideas:

org:"Example Corp"	all exposed assets
port:22 country:US	SSH sweep (academic)
product:OpenSSH version:8.2p1	version pinpoint
vuln:CVE-2021-44228 product:Log4Shell	(curiosity) - note ethics: scanning is shown as research

Facets: Shodan groups by country/port/org – instant inventory

Censys: certificate & service search

`services.port:443` web; certificate name search finds certs for subdomains

Search a company's cert names → subdomain inventory (with crt.sh overlap)

The exposed-internet mindset

Attackers: "what can I reach without credentials?" = billions of Shodan rows

Defenders: "what do we expose that should be internal?" – this is YOUR daily job

Every exposed admin panel, database, or debug API you can demonstrate is a finding with a mitigation

Ethics police check

Search engines and Shodan offer **public data**. Using them responsibly (scoped, for inventory of your own assets, for threat research) is standard. Probing/attacking systems you find is NOT without authorization.

[← DNS Reconnaissance Deep](#)

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